



Venezuela Venezuelan Red Cross and IFRC

RESPONSE AND PROGRAMME UPDATE JUNE 2019



Red Cross Red Crescent Movement Cooperation

IFRC is present in Venezuela supporting the Venezuelan Red Cross (VRC) in addressing the humanitarian needs in country from two complementary angles:

- Coordinated response to increase access of vulnerable populations to health services
- Community-based approaches aimed at increasing households' and communities' resilience

For a greater impact of the Movement in addressing the growing hu-

manitarian needs, Venezuelan Red Cross (VRC), International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) and IFRC work in close collaboration promoting synergies and complementarity of its actions, as well as optimizing the use of its capacities and available resources.

The Movement's priorities consider a coordinated approach to sustain and strengthen VRC's capacities in key institutional areas for an effective emergency response and rele-

vant humanitarian programming.

IFRC and ICRC are supporting VRC branches and headquarters conducting relevant trainings, developing tailored security and safety

protocols, equipping volunteers with institutional visibility and defining additional VRC human resource capacity dedicated to coordinate security related aspect.



IFRC APPEAL VENEZUELA: HEALTH EMERGENCY



The health situation in Venezuela continues to be critical while the country is facing a growing crisis.

During the past years, the health system has rapidly deteriorated as a result of the socioeconomic situation and other factors. In one way or another, the entire health system has been affected at all levels.

- Hospitals and other health facilities are not able to secure essential supplies, medical staff, uninterrupted basic services and other resources needed to respond to the health needs

of the population, from primary health services to treat life-threatening conditions as cancer.

- The pharmaceuticals that are available in the market are not accessible to a big part of the population since drug prices have skyrocketed, along with those for food and other necessities.



The Appeal seeks CHF 50 million to meet the urgent needs of the most vulnerable population for health care

by enhancing the operating capacity of public hospitals and the network of health facilities operated by the Venezuelan Red Cross across the country. This approach includes the supply and rapid deployment of essential medical supplies, including pharmaceuticals and generators; outreach to remote communities with comprehensive primary health services; improve the provision of mental health and

psychosocial services. Where needed, basic infrastructure of water and sanitation in health facilities will be improved to ensure safe water and adequate sanitation facilities.

IFRC VENEZUELA APPEAL: HEALTH EMERGENCY



Operations Update

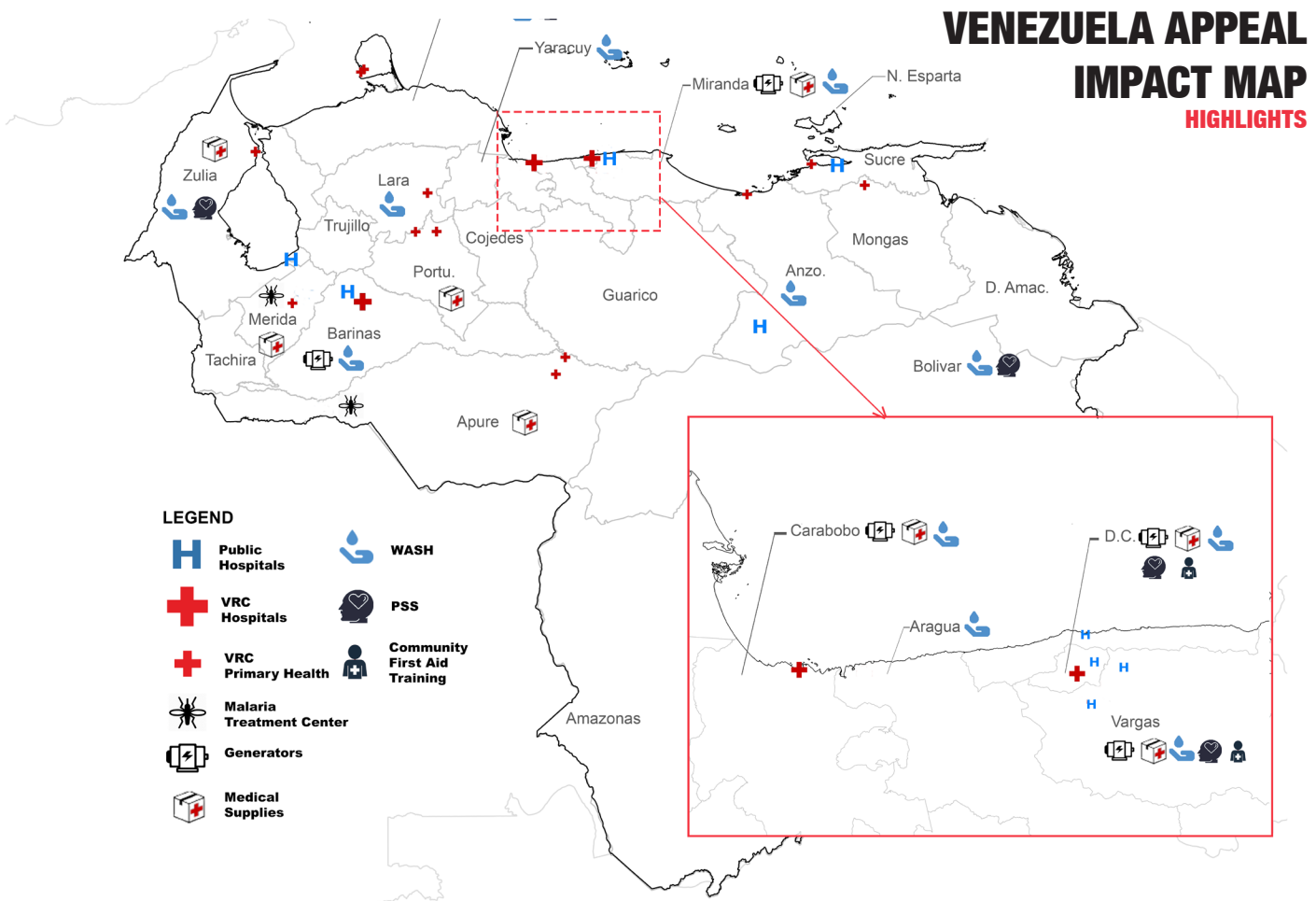
IFRC's emergency funds, released in January 2019, provided families with items to store and purify water, supplied medical stocks, and provided communities with basic and emergency health care for the injured.

As of June 2019, with the support from IFRC Appeal Venezuela: Health Emergency, five public hospitals

and eleven Venezuelan Red Cross (VRC) hospitals and primary health care centres were equipped with generators and/or essential medical supplies, including pharmaceuticals for the provision of basic health care and first aid. Technical assessments were conducted by IFRC technical experts in country and in the region to guide the priorities under the Ap-

peal. Technical and operational support to the VRC is at the centre of IFRC's priority. The distribution of the medical stocks and generators, as well as WASH interventions continue to be conducted in different areas of the country. VRC Psychosocial Response Teams were formed in three locations; standard psychosocial methodologies are being rolled

out in the branches. Psychological sessions were integrated in some of the community outreach health activities. In addition, IFRC is supporting the VRC volunteers with tools for their mental health self-care.



17 HEALTH FACILITIES SUPPORTED



9 VRC primary health centres
3 VRC hospitals
5 public hospitals

3 INTER AGENCY HEALTH KITS & OTHER MEDICAL SUPPLIES DISTRIBUTED



Provided to 4 public hospitals in Miranda, Vargas and Capital District states
2 VRC hospitals in Carabobo and Capital District states
4 VRC primary health centres Zulia, Apure, Portuguesa and Merida states

15 GENERATORS DISTRIBUTED



provided to 4 public hospitals in Barinas, Miranda, Vargas and Capital District states
2 VRC Hospitals in Barinas and Carabobo states
9 VRC primary health centres in nine states

2 PLANES



planes with humanitarian aid.

WITH THE SUPPORT FROM IFRC APPEAL VENEZUELA

Health Activities



459

people received first aid services from the VRC during public demonstrations



1,326

people received medicines during Community Health Sessions in Capital District



1

contingency plan for diarrheic diseases has been produced



539

people trained in first aid in different communities in Capital District and Vargas state

Malaria Prevention & Treatment



4,000

mosquito nets/curtains will reach Apure, Merida, Zulia and Puerto Cabello in Carabobo state

2

malaria treatment kits are provided to two Malaria Treatment Centres in Apure and Merida complementing the interagency efforts in other areas of the country.

WASH



12,224

people received Jerry Cans



12

VRC branches were equipped with boots, 3 branches received protective and visibility equipment for volunteers

Psychosocial support (PSS) and Mental Health



136

people reached with psychosocial support activities



22

people received mental health care awareness



4

VRC branches were equipped with standard PSS tool kit to provide PSS to communities in Capital District, Zulia, Bolivar and Vargas



3

VRC PSS Response teams were trained and formed in Capital Districts, Bolivar and Barinas



Funding immediate priorities:



Ensure an uninterrupted supply of essential medical stocks including pharmaceuticals, medical consumables and medical equipment



Provision of comprehensive primary health care in remote communities



Ensure the needed operating capacity of IFRC Venezuela country office and Venezuelan Red Cross



Continue equipping health facilities across the country with electric generators



Improve basic water and sanitation systems in health facilities



136

VRC PSS Response teams were trained and formed in Capital District, Bolivar and Barinas



VRC volunteers and personnel care Psychosocial support provided to VRC personnel and volunteers by IFRC specialized staff

Mental health self-care tools were developed and are being disseminated across VRC branches and sub-branches



Principled Action

IFRC and VRC have an important level of access to reach the communities in urgent need of health assistance and humanitarian programming in accordance with the Fundamental Principles of the International Red Cross and Red Crescent Movement.

The delivery of humanitarian assistance is conducted only if independence, neutrality and impartiality are adhered to when providing humanitarian aid.

VENEZUELAN RED CROSS AND IFRC COUNTRY PLAN



The Country Operational Plan 2019–2020 with a budget of CHF 13 million aims to support the National Society in five areas of focus.

At the center is enhancing the institutional capacity of Venezuelan Red Cross.

Country plan facilitates a shared vision of priorities, guiding the development of community interventions, promotes fostering alliances and mobilizing resources to meet the identified needs, and coordinating with partners.



Country Plan Implementation Progress by Area of Focus



Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR)

6,200 People Reached



Livelihoods and basic Needs

3,500 people reached



Health

8,100 patients



Water, Sanitation and Hygiene

25,000 people reached



Protection, Gender and Inclusion

3,000 people on the move reached

